

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Referrals That Do Not Lose the Patient

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C30
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Design referral intelligence that preserves continuity, acknowledgement, urgency, capacity, handoff, closure, privacy, and clinical authority.

Why it matters

A referral recorded as sent can still lose the patient when receipt, follow-up, and closure are not verified.

Illustrative application

An urgent referral remains open until the receiving service acknowledges capacity and records a governed outcome.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.